

Dog fight: augmented reality

Watch the AR Drone dog fight video at <http://cnet.co/h9ms36>

Sphero

Watch the Sphero in action at <http://bit.ly/fSvOjX>



Drone of its hull shield to give you greater control. The Drone experience becomes even more fun when you install the AR Pursuit app (which is currently available only on the Apple app store) on your iPhone to have crazy fight rounds with your friend. No toy comes close to the kind of fun you can have battling it out in a dog fight with your friend in an open ground.

We've already covered the Orbotix Sphero ball which was unveiled at CES this year. Sphero is a 74-mm orb approximately the size of a baseball. It can be controlled using an iPhone or iPad, you can move it around in different directions and it changes colour. Well that's all the information revealed about this crazy bot ball, it's going to release later at the end

Smart bots to play with!

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As kids, we were content with the small G.I. Joe or the disproportionately brawny He-Man toys we had. Toys have become smarter today. They have a mind of their own. As absurd as it may sound, these smart toys are capable of interacting with their environment and with each other. These toys have a developed AI that can be further enhanced to make them even more interactive.

An interesting trend in toy development has surfaced over the years – you no longer need expertise and technical know how to develop your own toy bot. All you need is a few lines of code and basic moveable hardware. You can control your creation by using a smart phone and the best part is there are apps specifically designed for it. All of this is possible as toy building components have become cheaper, flexible and more standardised over the years giving any budding toy developer to play around with his imagination.

The obvious question we find ourselves asking is – are these still toys and are they meant for kids only? That is certainly not the case, these toys are enjoyed by kids and adults alike, let's have a look at some

Even your toys are getting intelligent these days. Here's a closer look at some brainy tech toys!

of these smart bots we'd love to play with, but first let's go down memory lane.

Ghosts of toys past!

We all have seen copters and cars that are controlled using a remote control; but in the good old days, the remote used to be wired to the car so you had to literally run behind the car once it achieved some acceleration. And how can we forget the obstacle avoiding robot? It changed its course each time it hit an obstacle. These were the 'smart toys' we grew up playing with.

Control'em with your phone

A very popular toy is the AR parrot drone. The iPhone/iPad controlled copter was featured in Drool maal in June 2010 and is surely droolworthy. The AR Drone is a pretty cool concept, it uses Augmented Reality as the base technology which means its potential is almost limitless. The Drone has two cameras, one mounted on its head and the other on its base which makes its navigation seamless. You can enjoy flying the drone both indoor and outdoor. While indoor, use the full hull shield that is provided to protect it against impacts with walls. Out in the open you can rid the



AR Drone parrot_AR.Drone_color18

of this year. Developers Ian and Adam do not reveal any other 'cool feature' as they claim that the Sphero has, well we just have to wait and watch all that the robotic ball can do. However some rumours about its design suggest that the Sphero might have light notification system for email or SMS you receive on your phone.

Okay so far we have seen a helicopter and a shiny ass ball which can be controlled using your smartphones or tablets, but what about the toy category we all grew up playing? Yeah we are talking about a smart car bot. Unlike the AR Drone and Sphero there is no proper car model that we could have covered, guess we all just have to wait for CES next year for it to show up considering the way things have been moving so far. However a lot of independent devel-